

#facebook

The social media giant Facebook rolled out the Twitter-like hashtag support. Will it succeed?

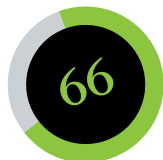
#fbfails

Perhaps not! You can use but can't search for more than one hashtag simultaneously, unlike Twitter

Bazaar

ECS Z87H3 A2X Extreme

Haswell board enticing gamers



Features	70
Overclocking.....	55
Build Quality	80
Value for money	60

Specifications

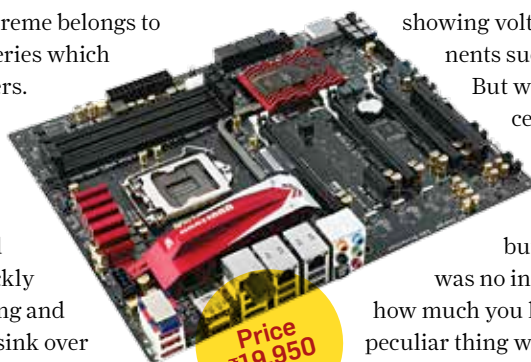
Socket: LGA 1150; **Chipset:** Intel Z87; **PCIe x16 slots:** 3; **USB 3.0 ports:** 4; **SATA Ports:** 7; **LAN ports:** 2; **Display ports:** 1xHDMI, 1xDisplayPort

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ECS Z87H3 A2X Extreme belongs to the L337 Gaming series which is targeted at gamers. At first glance, this board does look the part - sharply design heatsinks for both VRMs and the chipset, gold plated capacitors, buttons for quickly accessing BIOS, overclocking and so on. The Qooltech V heatsink over the VRMs also has a small fan to provide active cooling as well. A heat-pipe joins the chipset heatsink with the Qooltech one. On the chipset heatsink, you have a temperature sensitive sticker. Just behind the DIMM slots, you have voltage monitoring points.

We tested the board using the Intel Core i7-4770K and the scores obtained were in line with the ASRock Z87 Extreme 4. The overclocking utility, eOC wasn't really that helpful as if was just



Price
₹19,950

showing voltages that too of components such as RAM, PCH and so on.

But we could overclock the processor using Intel's Extreme Tuning utility to a stable 4.6GHz over air. Overclocking using the OC button proved futile as there was no indication on the screen as to how much you have overclocked. Another peculiar thing we noted was that even though we had set all cores to say 4.6GHz, while running the benchmark, the processor speeds fell to 4.4GHz.

The Z87H3-A2X is certainly an improvement over the previous generation ECS boards and we quite like the heatsink design. Barring overclocking features, it is packed to the gills with connectivity options and good components. But around ₹17,000 MOP, it's too early to recommend this board.

Nimish Sawant

ASRock Z87 Extreme 4

An impressive feature set with a good overclocking utility

The main points to take into consideration with the Z87 chipset is that it has support for six SATA 6 Gbps ports (as opposed to only two in Z77), native support for 1600MHz of RAM speeds (as opposed to 1333MHz native on the Z77) and six USB 3.0 native support (four in Z77). The ASRock Z87 Extreme 4 comes in a brown body with black coloured slots and heatsinks. The heat-sinks are sturdy but appear quite compact. It sports eight SATA ports (two supported by an ASMedia controller), gold-plated capacitors, three PCIe x16 Gen 3 (in x16, x8 and x4 configurations) and dual-BIOS. The interesting features present on the board includes an HDMI-in port, which allows you to connect an HDMI input from your console or your tablet and with the help of any HDMI

switch, toggle between your system's display and the HDMI input. The board also supports Intel's Remote Wake Technology which allows you to control your system remotely using the ASRock Home Cloud utility.

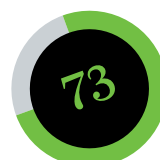
The UEFI BIOS looks good, but it is not as detailed as the Intel reference board. Overclocking is quite easy thanks to the ASRock A-Tuning utility. We could overclock the 4770K to 4.6GHz getting a Cinebench R11.5 score of 10.47 - a 24 per cent jump from stock settings.



Price
₹12,999

Looking at the feature set and ease of overclocking with the utility as well as from the BIOS, it makes a decent purchase for someone looking at mainstream Haswell system. The MRP of ₹12,999 looks competitive, but it is still early days for a recommendation.

Nimish Sawant



Features	70
Overclocking.....	75
Build Quality	75
Value for money	70

Specifications

Socket: LGA 1150; **Chipset:** Intel Z87; **PCIe x16 slots:** 3; **Display ports:** 1xHDMI-out, 1xHDMI-in, 1xD-Sub, 1xDVI-D, 1xDisplayPort; **USB 3.0 ports:** 4; **LAN Port:** 1; **SATA ports:** 8; **Audio Codec:** Realtek ALC1150

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